

Crime Lord

Ruler of the Underworld

"I don't really care about the Greeks, but I have lots of contacts in the Undermarket, and I will use them to generate lots of cash."

Setup

1. Sit to the left of the Warmonger.
2. Choose a color then take the Player Screen, Leaders (dice), Alliance Tokens, and one Card Marker of your color. Place everything behind your Player Screen.
3. Place one of your Alliance Tokens on the start of the Honor Track.
4. Keep one of your Alliance Tokens for each player (including yourself) and put the rest back in the box.
 - a. You should start with 6 Alliance Tokens in a 6-player game.

Checkpoint

1. Find one copy of the following Investments and put them face-up in front of your Player Screen:
 - a. BLOOD PACT
 - b. DANGEROUS PROMISES
 - c. WARY GUARDS
 - d. ABUSIVE POWER
2. Place a non-player die, with value 2, on each of your Investments, denoting their level.
3. Move four of your Leaders out in front of your Player Screen, each with level 2. The rest of your Leaders cannot be used yet.
4. Find one copy of the following Law, place one of your Card Markers on the top of the card, and place it face-up at the front of the Law Queue.
 - a. SUSPICIOUS ADVISORS
5. Find one copy of the following Scheme and put it in your hand.
 - a. HUMILIATION

Checkpoint

1. Take the Scheme pouches and put two card markers from each player into each pouch. Give each player one of the filled pouches and set any extras aside.

“This is your Scheme Pouch, and you will use it to secretly submit Scheme cards to attack other players. Keep it behind your screen so other players don’t notice when you put cards into it.”

Checkpoint

“In this game, we play as leaders of the provinces of the ancient Persian empire. Our primary enemies of the time are the Greeks on our western border. The Great King rules over all of us, but he generally trusts us to keep our provinces in good working order. As long as we maintain the border and follow the Laws of the Land, we are free to do as we wish. Technically, we are all on the same team against the Greeks, but we all know some team players are more valuable than others. At the end of the game, the province that holds the most Honor wins. As we play, we will gain Honor for winning battles, deploying lots of Troops, and winning lawsuits. At the end of the game, we will gain Honor for having alliances, Spies, Troops, and the King’s Favor. May the best Province win!”

Round 1

Action Phase

1. **Collect** 4 Commodities.

“I want some Commodities, but the Market Rate is not worth Buying them, so I will Collect some for free. This action gives me 2 Commodities per Leader Level, so I will gain 4 Commodities. This does not change the Market Rate.”

2. **Sell** 4 Commodities for 4 Coins using BLOOD PACT and DANGEROUS PROMISES.

“This Market Rate is a great time to Sell Commodities, so I will do so. Typically, the Court Buy and Sell provide better rates, but I get a better rate if I Sell to the Undermarket because of my Investments. When Selling, you can gain up to 1 Coin per Leader Level, paying the appropriate Commodities, but my Dangerous Promises Investment increases that max by 2, so I will get up to 4 Coins. Normally, I would have to spend 3 Commodities per Coin since the Market Rate is 2 and Undermarket increases that rate by 1, but my Blood Pact Investment lowers that rate by 2, so I only have to spend 1 Commodity per Coin. I will pay 4 Commodities and take 4 Coins from the Free Bank. I’m not dealing with the King, so I don’t have to worry about the Royal Bank. Now that my trade is done, I increase the Market Rate by 1 since Commodities are slightly more common.”

3. **Recruit** 2 Troops.

4. You have no more leaders, so you must pass

“I used my other leader earlier when I Negotiated with the Head Banker, so I will pass for the rest of the round.”

Report Phase

1. After everyone has collected their Leaders,

“Time to see what secret attacks happened last round! I will open each pouch, one by one, and resolve each Scheme I find in the pouch. Each Scheme needs one Spy in the pouch, so if there are not enough Spies, the extra Schemes will get discarded.”

2. After checking all Scheme pouches,

“Now that we have resolved any Schemes, I will reset the card markers in these pouches and redistribute them.”

Round 2

- At some point in the next round, subtly **scheme** against the Chief Scribe.
 - Choose the HUMILIATION scheme card and grab a card marker for the Chief Scribe from your pouch.
 - Put the Chief Scribe’s card marker on the top of the scheme card (the target of the scheme).
 - Put the marked scheme card into the pouch with all the rest of the card markers.
 - Put your Spy into the pouch.

Action Phase

1. **Flatter** for the King’s Favor and 1 Coin.

“I’ll take that King’s Favor.”

2. **Undermarket Buy** 4 Commodities with 2 Coins.

“I would love to use the Court Buy since I don’t have any Investments, but the Master of Lies already took that space, so I need to go to the Undermarket and use the worse rate. I’ll pay 2 Coins to the Free Bank for 4 Commodities and decrease the Market Rate.”

3. **Undermarket Sell** for 4 Coins using BLOOD PACT and DANGEROUS PROMISES.

“That Market Rate dropped fast, so I’ll sell my Commodities right away!”

4. **Recruit** 2 Troops.

Report Phase

1. After everyone has collected their Leaders,

“It’s Scheme time again! Hopefully something happened this round. Each Scheme needs one Spy in the pouch, so if there are not enough Spies, the extra Schemes will get discarded. A Scheme card will have 1 or 2 card markers on it. The marker on the top of the card determines the Target, the player that has to read the card out loud and fulfill it. If there is a card marker on the bottom of the card, it determines the Receiver, the player that has a chance to benefit from the Target’s misfortune. Before the Target follows the instructions on the card, he will roll one non-player die. If the result is less than or equal to the half the number of his current Troops, his guards catch the Spy, and the Target discards the Scheme with no effect. If the result is greater than half his Troops, the Scheme succeeds, and he must follow the instructions. This is known as an Evasion Roll, and some investments improve your chance of defending a scheme. Some scheme instructions have a random value, known as a Damage Roll. Again some investments lower the potential damage of schemes. If the scheme has a Card Roll, use the result of another die roll. If the card has a Receiver, give the instructed resources to the Receiver.”

2. After checking all Scheme pouches,

“Now that we have resolved the Schemes, I will reset the card markers in these pouches and redistribute them.”

Round 3

Action Phase

1. **Undermarket Monetize**
2. **Undermarket Donate**

“I have a bunch of Coins that won’t give me any Honor at the end of the game, so I need to convert them into something that will. We get Honor for Troops, Spies, and Alliance Tokens at the end of the game, but it’s more efficient for me to Donate my Coins to the King in return for Honor. I may Donate 1 Coin per Leader Level, with Abusive Power enabling me to Donate 2 extra Coins in the Undermarket. I’ll only put 3 Coins in the Royal Bank since the fourth won’t benefit me and gain half (rounded up) the number of Coins I donated in Honor for a total of 2 Honor. The Undermarket penalty here works a little differently. Instead of giving me a worse rate, I have to demote the leader I used by 1 level after the action is complete. That’s a price I’m willing to pay since we are about to finish the game.”

- a. After finishing this action, trade any leftover coins to the Head Banker in exchange for his leftover Commodities.

“I’ve got some Coins I’m not going to use. Players can trade liquid assets (Coins and Commodities) at any time, even outside their turn, but anything else can only be traded by returning Alliance Tokens. I will give my leftover Coins to the Head Banker in exchange for his leftover Commodities. Hopefully, he can make use of them.”

3. **Negotiate** with the Head Banker.

Report Phase

1. After everyone has collected their Leaders,

“Time for some Schemes before we end the game.”

2. After checking all Scheme pouches,

“I won’t bother resetting these pouches since the game is about to end.”